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Julien Nyambal

Senior Machine Learning Engineer

Portfolio: juliennyambal.github.io
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AI and Data Engineering leader with 8+ years of experience delivering enterprise AI, cloud, and machine learning solutions across telecommunications, banking, fintech, and consulting industries across Africa.

Skills

AI & Machine Learning	Generative AI (LLMs), Machine Learning, MLOps
Data & Cloud Engineering	Python, SQL, Spark, Distributed Systems, Data Pipelines (ETL), Azure, AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes
Architecture & Leadership	Solution Architecture, Enterprise Architecture, AI Strategy, Team Leadership, Stakeholder Management
Tools & Languages	Git, Linux, Jupyter, LaTeX, English (Professional), French (Native)

Technical Experience

Manager: Data Engineering — **2023 — Present**
MTN Group – FinTech — *Johannesburg, South Africa*

- Lead BankTech data infrastructure across 7 African markets ($50M impact)
- Build scalable decisioninig systems for 60M+ customers
- Manage cross-functional data science and engineering teams
- Define Data governance and frameworks

Solution Architect — **2025 — 2026**
MTN Group – Strategy & Transformation — *Johannesburg, South Africa*

- Lead AI executive assistant development for MTN leadership
- Design LLM-based architecture using Azure OpenAI
- Drive GenAI integration into executive workflows

Technical Lead & AI Architect — **2022 — Present**
Reech (Startup) — *Remote*

- Designed AI strategy and recommendation systems (50% engagement increase)
- Led engineering team (5 members)
- Built scalable AI infrastructure and governance systems

Senior ML Engineer & Cloud Architect — **2022 — 2023**
Capitec Bank – Business Banking — *Johannesburg, South Africa*

- Led cloud migration for ML systems (70% cost reduction)
- Implemented MLOps pipelines for production AI
- Built customer segmentation models for business banking

Senior ML Engineer (Lead Consultant) — **2019 — 2022**
Entelect – Standard Bank CIB — *Johannesburg, South Africa*

- Built forex AI system generating $300K+ revenue
- Designed real-time financial ML architecture
- Developed NLP-based incident processing system
- Awarded Standard Bank Excellence Award

Machine Learning Engineer (Consultant) — **2018 — 2019**
Retro Rabbit — *Johannesburg, South Africa*

- Built ML models for customer segmentation (Nedbank Avo)
- Improved recommendation system performance by 75%
- Migrated systems from Hadoop to cloud containers

Education

PhD in Computer Science (Machine Learning) – Paused, *University of the Witwatersrand* — 2019 – 2023
MSc in Computer Science (Machine Learning & Computer Vision), *University of the Witwatersrand* — 2017 – 2018
BSc Honours in Computer Science – Distinction, *University of the Witwatersrand* — 2016
BSc in Computer Science & Mathematics, *University of Zululand* — 2012 – 2014

Activities

Winner, RAISE Your Hack 2025 (Global AI Hackathon) – MTN Group — 2025
Speaker, University of Limpopo – Future of Work in Data and AI — 2025
Technical Reviewer, Black in AI Workshop (NeurIPS) — 2019 – 2024
3rd Place, Deep Learning Indaba Competition (Automated Parking Detection) — 2017